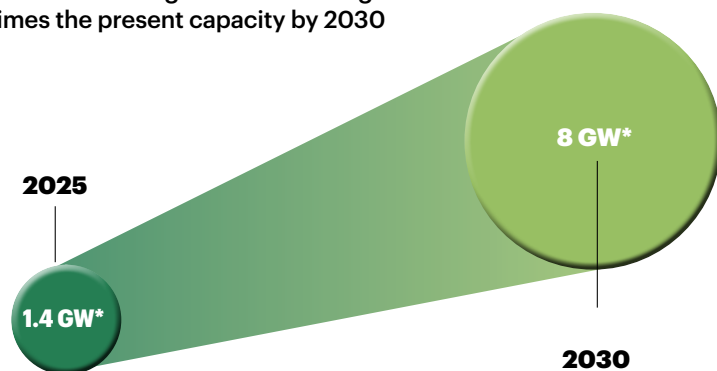


CAPACITY BUILD OUT

● India is now racing towards building four to six times the present capacity by 2030

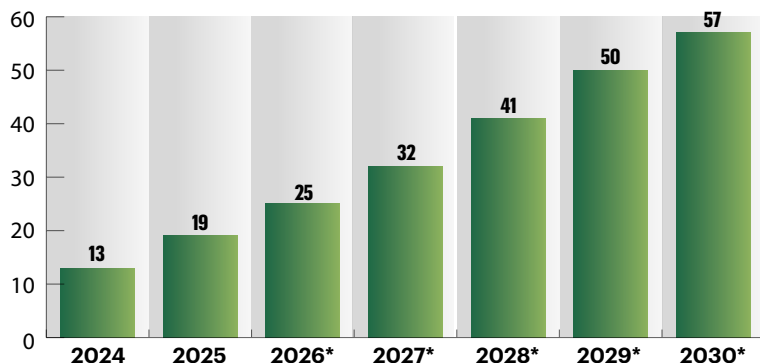


NOTE *CAPACITY

SOURCE ECONOMIC SURVEY 2026

POWER DEMAND

● India's energy demand for data centres is expected to more than double by 2030

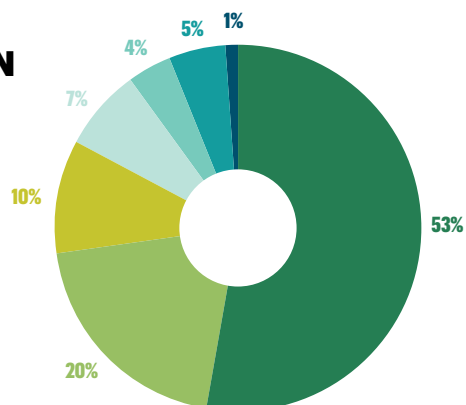


NOTE FIGURES IN TERAWATT-HOUR OR TWH; *2026 TO 2030 ARE PROJECTIONS

SOURCE C&B GLOBAL

WHERE ARE THE DATA CENTRES IN INDIA?

■ MUMBAI
■ CHENNAI
■ DELHI NCR
■ BENGALURU
■ HYDERABAD
■ PUNE
■ KOLKATA



SOURCE CBRE

midable environmental challenge. What starts as a prompt on Gemini, CoPilot, Claude, Anthropic et al to answer a query, generate an image, create videos, etc, goes into a football-field-sized data centre stacked with hundreds of GPUs. These chips generate answers and consume resources at a scale that is beginning to rival heavy industry and even city power demands.

A simple prompt like 'who will win the 2026 FIFA World Cup' will consume as much power as running a microwave for one second. Multiply that by billions of queries to generate answers, videos, future aircraft design, etc.

"The wave of data-centre development in India is poised to significantly impact water resources and electricity consumption. They often use substantial water for cooling purposes, which could strain local water supplies, especially in water-scarce regions," says Anjal Prakash, professor of public policy, Flame University and lead author, Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change report.

India's electricity grid already faces seasonal stress during peak summer months. According to the Ministry of Power, peak summer demand surges 8-12% over regular demand. Adding clusters of hyper-scale AI facilities could push local systems to the brink unless power generation and transmission networks expand in parallel.

Not surprisingly, in a water and power-starved country, leaning on AI to transform the economy is easier said than done. Vibhuti Garg, Director, South Asia, Institute of Energy Economics and Financial Analysis, says, "India's data centre boom is a double-edged sword. It will underpin the digital economy, but it will also intensify pressure on electricity systems, water